



## A Structured Blueprint for Identification, Prioritization, and Execution of Growth Adjacencies

JBG Business Fellowship Program

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# The Strategic Challenge: Capital Constraints in a Diversified Group

## NAVIGATING SOURCED PIPELINE SATURATION AND SILOED RESOURCE ALLOCATION

### The Bottleneck: Resource Dispersion

JBG's footprints across Software (JCS), Clean Energy (Nature Grid), and Human Resources (Aequalis) represent high-growth vectors, but decentralized allocations dilute overall Group impact:

- **Sourced Pipeline Saturation:** Over 20+ opportunities compete for growth budgets simultaneously.
- **Operational Limits:** Strict constraints on software engineering bandwidth and management oversight.
- **Subjective Allocation Bias:** Historical budgets influenced by internal preference rather than quantitative criteria.

### The Solution: A Structured Growth Funnel

We propose a standardized filtering process that screens opportunities for capability fit and economics before scaling pilot investments:

- 1 **Phase 1: Diagnose Core Health** (Audit cost structures, current client margins)
- 2 **Phase 2: Scorecard Prioritization** (Filter opportunities by weighted factors)
- 3 **Phase 3: Validate Market Pilots** (Deploy low-code B2B SaaS simulators)

**Strategic Takeaway:** Establishing a quantitative filtering funnel prevents JBG from diluting capital and focus across too many concurrent initiatives.



# Portfolio Diagnostics: Baseline Core & Adjacencies

## REVIEWING JBG'S CURRENT FOOTPRINT AND LOW-RISK GROWTH PATHWAYS

### JCS (TECHNOLOGY)

#### Core: Software Consulting

Custom software dev, CRM/ERP solutions, and application support.

#### Growth Adjacency:

Move from custom projects to **international managed service retainers** to secure stable monthly revenue.

### NATURE GRID (ENERGY)

#### Core: Residential Solar

Solar installations and system setup for residential properties.

#### Growth Adjacency:

Shift focus to **Commercial & Industrial (C&I) projects** and long-term **O&M service agreements**.

### AEQUALIS GLOBAL (HR)

#### Core: Executive Search

Transactional recruitment placements and bulk hiring searches.

#### Growth Adjacency:

Transition manual searches into high-margin **recurring contract staffing retainers**.

**Strategic Takeaway:** Maximizing Group value begins by migrating transactional services (one-off projects/hires) to recurring contract models.



# The Opportunity Prioritization Scorecard



A QUANTITATIVE MATRIX TO STANDARDIZE CAPITAL AND RESOURCE ALLOCATION

| DIMENSION              | EVALUATION FACTOR     | WEIGHT | HIGH SCORE CRITERIA (10/10)                           |
|------------------------|-----------------------|--------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Market Potential (40%) | Market Attractiveness | 20%    | Large TAM (\$500M+), double-digit CAGR.               |
|                        | Revenue Potential     | 20%    | Recurring SaaS subscriptions or multi-year contracts. |
| Strategic Fit (30%)    | JBG Capability Fit    | 15%    | Leverages JCS developers and current client bases.    |
|                        | Brand Synergy         | 15%    | Fits JBG's technology and sustainability focus.       |
| Feasibility (20%)      | Competitive Intensity | 10%    | Fragmented market with low technology penetration.    |
|                        | Ease of Execution     | 10%    | Low regulatory hurdles, fast time-to-market.          |
| Risk & Capex (10%)     | Capital Efficiency    | 5%     | Asset-light software/SaaS models with low capex.      |
|                        | Risk Mitigation       | 5%     | Low regulatory, technical, or delivery liabilities.   |

### Evaluation Protocol

Opportunities are rated 1–10 across these 8 factors, resulting in a weighted score out of 100:

$$S_{opp} = \sum (Weight_i \times Score_i)$$

 **MVP Gate Threshold:** Opportunities must score  $\geq 65/100$  to qualify for seed validation funding.

**Strategic Takeaway:** Establishing a quantitative scorecard filters subjective opinions out of the investment process and protects capital.





# Prioritized Adjacencies: JBG Growth Engine



RANKING SOURCED PROJECTS TO MAXIMIZE ROI AND CROSS-BUSINESS SYNERGY

| RANK | STRATEGIC OPPORTUNITY                | SCORE    | SYNERGY MECHANICS                                     | BUSINESS MODEL            |
|------|--------------------------------------|----------|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| 1    | B2B Recruitment Automation SaaS      | 84 / 100 | JCS software engineering + Aequalis staffing network  | Monthly Subscription SaaS |
| 2    | Solar Telemetry & Predictive O&M     | 78 / 100 | JCS IoT cloud platforms + Nature Grid field engineers | Telemetry + O&M Retainers |
| 3    | JCS Template & Connector Marketplace | 72 / 100 | Productizing custom CRM/ERP integration modules       | Reusable API Licenses     |

## Strategic Logic

Rather than funding unrelated ventures, we prioritize **cross-business synergies** where one unit's technology capability (JCS) scales another unit's customer relationships (Aequalis, Nature Grid).

High

MARGIN SAAS

Low

CAC CROSS-SELL

**Strategic Takeaway:** Prioritizing B2B SaaS models allows JBG to capture recurring licensing fees without linear headcount growth.



# Opportunity #1: B2B Recruitment Automation SaaS



## PIVOTING AEQUALIS GLOBAL FROM A SERVICES BUYER TO A SAAS VENDOR

### Synergy Mechanics: JCS + Aequalis

Aequalis currently pays third-party software databases for sourcing candidates. By productizing our own tool, we capture high-margin recurring fees:

- 1. Custom AI Engine:** JCS builds automated candidate matching and resume screening pipelines.
- 2. Warm Distribution Channel:** Aequalis cross-sells the software to their existing mid-market clients.

### Target Economics

Captures corporate recruitment budgets by automating labor-intensive resume matching.

**70%**

TIME SAVED

**\$2k+**

ARPU / MONTH

**Strategic Takeaway:** Cross-selling proprietary software to Aequalis's client base bypasses early customer acquisition costs (CAC).



# Opportunity #2: Solar Telemetry & Predictive O&M SaaS

## GENERATING RECURRING SOFTWARE REVENUES ON TOP OF SOLAR INSTALLATIONS

### Synergy Mechanics: JCS + Nature Grid

Solar panel installations are one-time capital transactions. By bundling monitoring software, we lock in long-term servicing relationships:

- 1. Cloud Monitoring:** JCS builds solar telemetry dashboards tracking active kW yields and kWh generation.
- 2. O&M Alert Dispatches:** Systems auto-detect panel dust, sending Nature Grid maintenance crews to clean.

### Commercial Value

Transforms commodity solar installations into stable, multi-year recurring service retainers.

**100%**

LIVE TELEMETRY

**15%**

YIELD INCREASE

**Strategic Takeaway:** Bundling solar telemetry software turns Nature Grid's hardware sales into predictable recurring service revenue.



# Opportunity #3: JCS Integration Template Marketplace

## TRANSITIONING FROM LOW-MARGIN PROJECTS TO REUSABLE API MARKETPLACE ASSETS

### The Productization Shift

Traditional IT consulting requires custom design for every contract. We propose packaging standard integration layers into reusable templates:

- **Common Connectors:** Pre-built ERP-to-CRM pipelines and database connectors.
- **Template Library:** Sell templates under licensing fees rather than custom service contracts.
- **Resource Efficiency:** Shrinks custom development delivery times by 50%.

### Operational Efficiency

Standardizes common deployment scripts and modules, freeing developer headcount for complex custom work.

**50%**

TIME TO DEPLOY

**2x**

CAPACITY / DEV

**Strategic Takeaway:** Productizing integration components scales JCS revenues without a linear increase in developer headcount.





# B2B Growth Enablement: Marketing & GTM Strategy



DIGITAL MARKETING, SALES INTEGRATION, AND INTER-GROUP CROSS-SELLING

## 1. INBOUND MARKETING

### Lead Generation Engine

Deploy SEO, technical case studies, and **free online calculators** (e.g. Solar savings or HR matching ROI calculators) to drive organic B2B leads.

## 2. SALES INTEGRATION

### Cross-Training & Bundles

Train Aequalis account reps to bundle JCS software development, and Nature Grid reps to bundle telemetry software with C&I panels.

## 3. INCENTIVE ALIGNMENT

### Commission Models

Establish cross-sell commission structures. Reward Aequalis recruiters and solar reps for converting clients into recurring SaaS subscriptions.

**Strategic Takeaway:** Cross-training account executives and structuring cross-sell commissions turns JBG into a unified sales engine.



# Pre-Investment Checklist: Due Diligence Gates

## REQUIRED INFORMATION AND VALIDATION GATES BEFORE COMMITTING SCALE CAPITAL

### Required Research Inputs

Before allocating final development and sales budgets, JBG management must verify these 4 parameters:

- 1. Market TAM Validation:** Verify sector CAGRs and mid-market buyer densities using Gartner and IDC data.
- 2. Competitive Audits:** Map pricing, features, and contract values of existing SaaS competitors.
- 3. Regulatory Compliance:** Audit state-level net metering, solar credits, and candidate privacy regulations (GDPR/DPD).
- 4. Technical Prototypes (POCs):** Conduct JCS developer hackathons to verify API integrations.

### The Customer Pilot Gate

Before writing any software code, JBG must present interactive simulators to **5 strategic clients**. Capital is only allocated if at least **3 clients** express intent-to-buy at the targeted subscription price.

**Strategic Takeaway:** Committing growth capital requires quantitative verification of market demand, competitive space, and technical scope.



# Execution Roadmap: 90-Day Implementation Plan

## MILESTONES ACROSS DIAGNOSIS, DESIGN, AND VALIDATION WORKSTREAMS

### DAYS 1 – 30

#### Phase 1: Diagnose

- Audit JCS developer utilization rates and availability.
- Analyze Nature Grid commercial margins.
- Map Aequalis's client database for warm SaaS cross-sell candidates.

### DAYS 31 – 60

#### Phase 2: Design

- Build interactive B2B simulators for solar and HR platforms.
- Score all pipeline ideas using the prioritized scorecard.
- Design integration template schemas.

### DAYS 61 – 90

#### Phase 3: Validate

- Present interactive simulators to 5 target B2B clients.
- Collect pilot feedback and finalize pricing.
- Acquire initial paid pilot letters of intent.

**Strategic Takeaway:** A structured 90-day timeline prevents 'zombie projects' by enforcing clear exit gates at each phase.



# Group Governance: Success Metrics & Exit Gates

TRACKING KPIS ACROSS PORTFOLIO HEALTH, UNIT ECONOMICS, AND FAIL-FAST GATES

## PORTFOLIO HEALTH

### Group Level Metrics

- EBITDA margin expansion
- Group Return on Invested Capital (ROIC)
- Software developer resource utilization %

Portfolio Gate

## UNIT ECONOMICS

### Commercial Viability

- LTV : CAC Ratio (Target > 3.0x)
- Cash payback cycle under 12 months
- Subscription churn rate under 1.5% / month

Commercial Gate

## DISCIPLINE GATE

### Fail-Fast Rules

- Strict 60-day development milestones
- Automatic exit if an MVP has < 2 paid signups in 60 days
- Target > 70% early rejection rate for ideas

Governance Gate

**Strategic Takeaway:** Corporate discipline requires funding winners and terminating unviable projects before capital is exhausted.